1901–1953



“THE JANA SANGH STANDS FOR CREATING CONDITIONS OF TRUE NATIONALISM IN INDIA WHICH MUST BE THE HOMELAND OF PEOPLE PURSUING DIVERSE FAITHS AND RELIGIONS…WE STAND FOR ONE COUNTRY, ONE NATION AND ONE CULTURE.”

Syama Prasad Mookerjee was an educationist and politician from Bengal. An excellent orator and member of the Constituent Assembly, he was part of Nehru’s first cabinet but resigned in 1950 over the government’s policies on Pakistan. In 1951, he founded the Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS) to be the political face of the Hindu nationalist Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS). According to Mookerjee, one of his goals in founding the BJS was to establish a strong opposition in Parliament, as he believed this was an important part of any democracy. The BJS was the predecessor of the present-day Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).

RAM MANOHAR LOHIA

1910–1967